the arts. His belief in the need for infrastructure and heavy industry led to investment in these areas, including the construction of large dams and facilities that remain in operation today. Most importantly, he kept the fragile new country together through several crises, including communal violence, war, food shortages, agitation in the states and disagreements within the government. This, perhaps, is his most enduring legacy, an ideal for successive generations to strive towards: a democratic, modern, culturally diverse and yet united India.



Even after he took office, Nehru made it a point to make time to listen to ordinary Indians' concerns. Members of the public could visit the prime minister in his residence to bring matters to his attention. Today, the residence he occupied is a library and museum.

INDIRA PRIYADARSHINI GANDHI

1917–1984